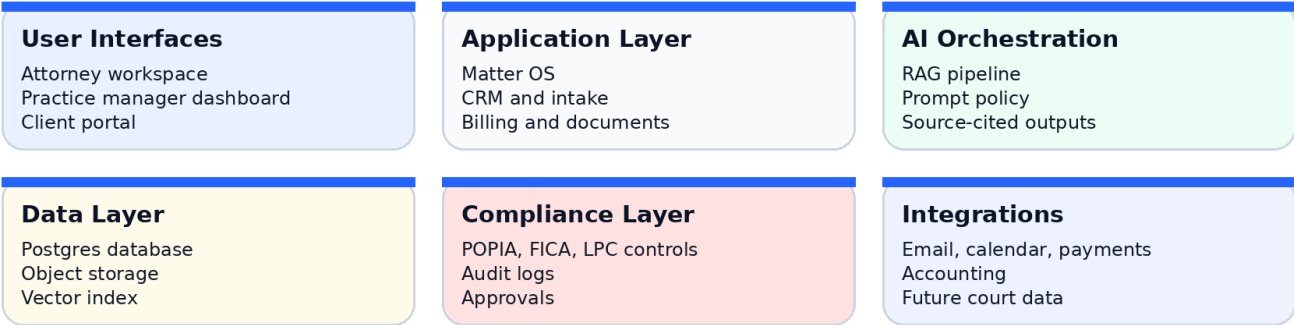


LEGAL MATTERS

Product Blueprint

A comprehensive strategy, architecture, workflow, AI, compliance, and build guide for a South African legal operating platform

Legal Matters Platform Architecture



Design principle: AI is embedded into verified workflows, not offered as an uncontrolled standalone chatbot.

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Prepared for	Legal Matters product development
Market focus	South African law firms and legal teams
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1. Executive Product Vision

North-star product promise

Legal Matters helps South African law firms run every matter with clarity, speed, compliance, and control — from first client intake to final invoice — using AI that understands the matter, checks the workflow, drafts the paperwork, flags risks, and keeps the firm accountable.

Legal Matters should be built as a legal command centre for South African law firms, not as a generic case-management system and not as a loose AI chatbot. The core product must combine matter management, client intake, document intelligence, deadlines, workflows, billing visibility, compliance controls, and embedded AI assistance into one secure workspace.

The product should make the everyday legal office feel more controlled. Attorneys, candidate attorneys, paralegals, practice managers, bookkeepers, and clients should each see exactly what they need to do, what is missing, what is risky, and what requires approval.

1.1 Strategic objectives

- Create a South African-first legal operating platform that understands local matter types, client onboarding, FICA, POPIA, LPC trust-account expectations, and practical law-firm operations.
- Reduce repetitive legal administration through AI-assisted intake, summaries, document extraction, drafting support, and matter-readiness checks.
- Improve firm revenue through time capture, billing visibility, invoice tracking, and billing-leakage detection.
- Reduce operational risk through deadline monitoring, matter inactivity alerts, source-cited AI, approval workflows, audit logs, and role-based permissions.
- Improve client service through structured updates, client portal access, document upload requests, secure messages, and matter status visibility.

1.2 Product identity

Dimension	Decision
Product category	AI-powered legal operating platform for South African law firms
Primary buyer	Solo attorneys, small firms, medium firms, practice managers, and specialist legal practices
Primary user	Attorneys, candidate attorneys, paralegals, legal secretaries, accounts staff, firm owners
Primary value	More control, less admin, fewer missed steps, better client updates, stronger billing discipline
Primary differentiator	South African legal workflow, compliance, document, and matter-readiness intelligence
MVP promise	A firm can manage clients, matters, deadlines, documents, AI summaries, tasks, and basic billing from one place

1.3 Product outcome metrics

Metric	Target outcome	Why it matters
Matter setup time	Reduce by 40-60%	Proves intake automation value
Document review time	Reduce by 50-70% for first-pass summaries	Proves AI document intelligence value
Overdue tasks	Reduce by 30%	Proves operational discipline

Unbilled work	Increase captured time by 10-25%	Proves revenue benefit
Client update frequency	Increase monthly updates per active matter	Proves client-service value
Matter readiness visibility	100% of active matters have readiness status	Proves control and risk visibility

2. Market Positioning and Filevine Lessons

The most useful lesson from Filevine is that the future of legal software is shifting from static case management toward an integrated legal operating intelligence system. Filevine markets AI features such as document review, AIFields, AI data mapping, DemandsAI, ValidationAI, and case-aware AI experiences. The strategic lesson is not to copy features blindly, but to treat AI as a workflow-native layer connected to documents, matter data, and firm operations.

2.1 What Filevine proves

Observation	Implication for Legal Matters
AI must be connected to case data	Legal Matters AI must be grounded in matter records, documents, notes, tasks, deadlines, and billing data.
AI document review is a high-value use case	Prioritise upload-classify-extract-summarise workflows early.
Validation and readiness checks are valuable	Build a Matter Readiness Engine for each practice area.
AI needs legal workflow context	Build workflow packs for South African legal processes.
A firm-wide operating system is stickier than a chatbot	Build one matter-centred workspace for legal and business operations.

2.2 Product positioning statement

Recommended positioning

Legal Matters is an AI-powered legal operating platform built specifically for South African law firms, combining matter management, document intelligence, workflow automation, compliance controls, billing visibility, and firm-wide operational intelligence.

2.3 Competitive positioning

Competitor type	Weakness	Legal Matters advantage
Generic CRM tools	Do not understand legal matters, deadlines, confidentiality, trust controls, or practice workflows	Matter-native legal workflows and compliance controls
Generic AI tools	Not safely connected to matter data and usually lack auditability	Source-cited AI with firm permissions and approval logs
International legal platforms	Often expensive and not South Africa-specific	Local workflow packs, POPIA/FICA/LPC-aware design, affordable pricing
Basic practice-management tools	Limited AI, weak document intelligence, limited risk visibility	AI matter intelligence, readiness scoring, risk radar, document extraction

3. South African Differentiation

The strongest market opportunity is local depth. South African firms need practical workflows, compliance checklists, document packs, client onboarding, and court/matter operations that reflect their daily reality.

3.1 Local compliance pillars

Pillar	Product interpretation
POPIA	Client consent, processing purpose, data minimisation, retention controls, privacy notices, AI processing controls, data access logs
FICA	Client identification, beneficial ownership where relevant, verification checklists, status tracking, document collection, accountable-institution workflow support
LPC and trust-account discipline	Matter-level accounting separation, trust transaction traceability, approval logs, FFC/trust-audit readiness support
PAIA	Information request management and firm policy document storage for applicable practices
Client confidentiality	Matter-level permissions, access logs, document restrictions, AI exclusion rules

3.2 Local matter templates

Practice area	Legal Matters workflow pack
Litigation	Pleadings, discovery, pre-trial, court dates, trial preparation, counsel brief, bundle readiness
Debt collection	Demand, section 129 where applicable, summons preparation, payment arrangements, execution tracking
Labour	Dismissal timeline, CCMA referral, evidence bundle, arbitration preparation, settlement options
Conveyancing	FICA, sale agreement, bond status, rates clearance, transfer duty, lodgement readiness
Estates	Death notice, will, executor appointment, inventory, L&D account, Master's Office steps
Family law	Divorce, maintenance, parenting plans, financial disclosure, settlement documents
RAF/personal injury	Accident data, medical records, chronology, quantum documents, evidence bundle
Commercial	Contract review, board/shareholder resolutions, transaction checklist, obligation tracker

3.3 Local language and client experience

- Plain-language client updates should be available in formal English, plain English, and optionally Afrikaans/Zulu/Xhosa templates in future phases.
- Client-facing communication must explain matter stages in non-technical language.
- Firms must be able to brand portal pages, letters, and client updates with their own letterhead and tone.

4. Product Principles and Non-Negotiables

Operating rule

Every feature should improve at least one of five outcomes: control, speed, compliance, revenue, or client experience.

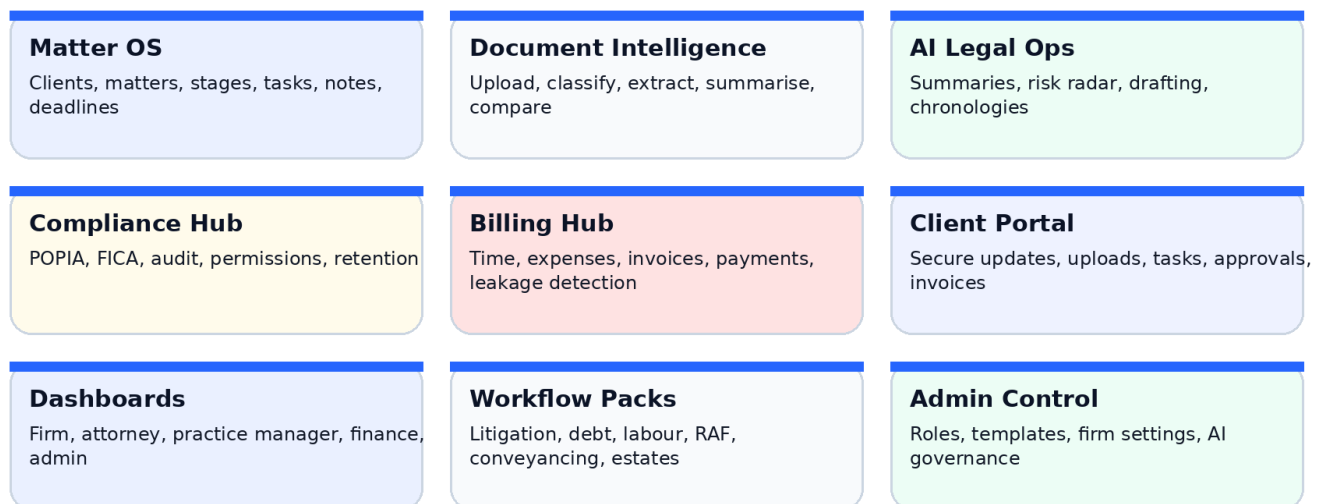
Principle	Meaning in product decisions
Matter-first	Every document, note, task, deadline, invoice, AI output, and message should connect to a matter.
Human-in-control AI	AI drafts and suggests; users approve, edit, send, or reject.
Source-cited outputs	AI must show source documents or fields used for important outputs.
Audit by default	Important actions are logged automatically.
Local workflow depth	South African practice-area workflows are a core feature, not an afterthought.
Role clarity	Partners, attorneys, paralegals, accounts staff, and clients should have different interfaces and permissions.
Progressive complexity	MVP should be simple enough to ship, but structured for enterprise-grade expansion.

4.1 Product red lines

- No uncontrolled AI sending messages directly to clients without human approval.
- No legal advice disclaimer replacing real verification controls; the platform must actively require source review and attorney approval.
- No trust-account processing without audit trails, role permissions, and reconciliation-ready records.
- No document extraction without storing provenance: which document, which page/section if available, extraction timestamp, and user approval status.
- No broad admin access to all matters unless explicitly granted by firm owners.

5. Core Platform Modules

Legal Matters Module Map



The MVP should prove value through matter control, document intelligence, deadline safety, and billing visibility.

5.1 Module overview

Module	Purpose	MVP scope
Firm Admin	Manage the tenant, users, roles, settings, templates, and billing plan	Firm profile, users, roles, permissions, audit log
Client CRM	Capture leads, clients, contacts, onboarding and conflict data	Client profiles, contacts, FICA/POPIA status, conflict check
Matter OS	Central matter workspace	Matter profile, stage, tasks, deadlines, notes, team, status
Document Hub	Manage documents and AI document intelligence	Upload, classify, AI summary, key extraction, version history
Workflow Engine	Guide matter progress by practice area	Templates, stages, required documents, readiness checks
AI Assistant	Embedded legal operations assistant	Matter summary, document summary, draft client update, suggested tasks
Billing Hub	Capture time, expenses and invoices	Time entries, expenses, invoices, unpaid and unbilled views
Client Portal	Improve client communication and document collection	Phase 2: secure status, uploads, tasks, invoices
Dashboards	Show what needs attention	Deadlines, overdue tasks, risk, unbilled work, AI actions

5.2 Matter OS requirements

- Matter number generation with firm-configurable prefixes.
- Matter type, stage, status, responsible attorney, team members, priority, risk level, and client link.
- Matter timeline containing events, notes, documents, tasks, deadlines, messages, invoices, and AI outputs.
- Matter health indicators: readiness score, deadline risk, inactivity risk, missing documents, billing status, client update status.
- Matter close workflow requiring final invoice status, document archive status, outstanding tasks, client closure communication, and data-retention policy confirmation.

5.3 Client CRM requirements

- Capture individuals and companies with contact details, identifiers, related parties, and communication preferences.
- Lead-to-client pipeline: enquiry, consultation booked, conflict check, onboarding, converted, declined, referred.
- Conflict-check workflow with names, companies, related parties, previous matters, opposing parties, and notes.
- POPIA consent, FICA status, signed mandate, engagement letter, fee agreement, and onboarding document status.
- Client communication history connected to matters where relevant.

5.4 Document Hub requirements

- Matter-specific folders with configurable categories such as pleadings, correspondence, client documents, financial, medical, evidence, drafts, signed documents, and court documents.
- Document metadata: type, uploaded by, upload date, version, status, confidentiality level, related deadline, AI processed yes/no, approval status.
- AI document summary, key field extraction, missing information detection, and suggested tasks.

- Version history for drafts and signed versions.
- Exportable bundle index for court, counsel, internal review, or client delivery.

5.5 Billing Hub requirements

- Time capture by matter, user, activity type, billable/non-billable status, hourly rate, narrative, and invoice status.
- Expenses and disbursements linked to matters.
- Draft invoices, issued invoices, paid invoices, overdue invoices, and write-offs.
- Billing leakage detection: activity without time entries, document work without time captured, emails/messages without time captured.
- Future integration with accounting platforms and payment gateways.

6. AI Product Suite

The AI suite should be productised into clear modules. This builds user trust and makes pricing easier. Instead of one generic assistant, Legal Matters should offer multiple AI capabilities with strong permissions, source references, and approval controls.

6.1 AI module catalogue

AI module	User value	Example output
Matter Intelligence	Understand matter status quickly	Matter brief, facts, risks, next steps, missing info
Document Intelligence	Turn documents into structured knowledge	Summary, parties, dates, amounts, obligations, deadlines
Deadline Intelligence	Reduce missed deadline risk	Suggested deadlines and reminder schedule
Risk Radar	Surface operational and legal risks	Prescription risk, inactive matter, missing mandate
Readiness Engine	Check if matter can move to next stage	Stage readiness score and missing requirements
Drafting Assistant	Create first drafts faster	Letters, checklists, client updates, summaries
Client Communication AI	Improve client updates	Plain-language matter update for approval
Billing Assistant	Improve revenue capture	Suggested time entry and billing narrative
Counsel Brief AI	Prepare counsel faster	Facts, issues, chronology, documents, questions
Bundle Builder AI	Prepare indexed bundles	Document index and bundle readiness checklist

6.2 AI operating model

1. User asks a matter-specific question or selects an AI action.
2. System checks permissions and AI policy for that firm, matter, and document set.
3. System retrieves structured matter data, approved documents, notes, deadlines, tasks, and relevant prior AI outputs.
4. AI generates a response with sources, confidence indicator, missing information, and recommended next step.
5. User reviews, edits, approves, rejects, or saves the output.
6. System logs the prompt category, sources used, output type, user action, and approval status.

6.3 AI output standard

Required field	Description
Output title	Clear purpose, e.g. “Matter Summary” or “Client Update Draft”
Generated content	The AI output itself
Sources used	Documents, fields, notes, or events used to generate the output
Confidence level	High/medium/low based on source completeness
Missing information	What the attorney should still obtain or verify
Suggested next action	Task, deadline, document request, or approval step
Human approval status	Draft, reviewed, approved, rejected, sent
Audit entry	Timestamp, user, matter, AI action, source set

6.4 Example AI matter intelligence output

Example: upload-to-intelligence experience

Matter Type: Debt Collection / Contract Dispute

Parties: Client: SunSmart Technologies; Opposing Party: ABC Electrical

Key Facts: Invoice amount R185,000; work completed 14 March 2026; payment due 31 March 2026.

Detected Risks: prescription date must be calculated; signed contract missing; debtor address must be verified.

Suggested Tasks: complete conflict check, upload signed agreement, draft letter of demand, verify debtor company registration, set follow-up deadline.

6.5 Guardrails for legal AI

- AI must not claim certainty where sources are incomplete.
- AI must not send external communication without user approval.
- AI must not draft final legal advice without marking it as attorney-review required.
- AI must not process documents excluded from AI by firm policy or matter policy.
- AI must log source references and user decisions.
- AI must flag assumptions clearly and ask for missing documents or data when needed.

7. Compliance, Trust, and Governance

Compliance must be treated as a product feature. Legal Matters will manage confidential client information, legal documents, financial data, deadlines, and potentially trust-account-related workflows. The trust layer must be visible and credible from the first version.

7.1 Compliance controls matrix

Area	Controls to implement
POPIA	Consent records, privacy notice templates, processing-purpose fields, retention settings, access logs, AI processing controls
FICA	KYC checklist, document requests, beneficial ownership capture where relevant, verification status, accountable-institution workflow guidance
LPC/trust readiness	Matter accounting separation, trust/client funds labelling, audit logs, approval workflows, exportable records for accountants/auditors
Confidentiality	Role-based access, matter restrictions, confidential document flags, restricted AI processing

AI governance	AI usage logs, source references, approval states, model/action policy, excluded documents
Auditability	Immutable event history for critical actions, exportable audit trails, admin review dashboards

7.2 Role-based access model

Role	Default capabilities
Firm owner / partner	All firm administration, billing visibility, matter oversight, user permissions, compliance settings
Attorney	Manage assigned matters, documents, tasks, deadlines, AI outputs, client communication drafts
Candidate attorney	Assigned matter work with approval requirements for external documents/messages
Paralegal / secretary	Document uploads, tasks, client information, communication drafts, workflow support
Accounts user	Invoices, payments, time reports, matter billing; limited legal documents by default
Client portal user	Own matter status, requests, uploads, invoices, messages
External counsel	Selected documents, brief, tasks, and communications only where explicitly shared

7.3 Audit log event types

Event category	Examples
Matter events	Matter created, stage changed, closed, reopened, risk changed
Document events	Uploaded, downloaded, viewed, classified, AI processed, version changed
AI events	Summary generated, draft generated, output approved, output rejected, source set used
Deadline events	Created, edited, completed, missed, escalated
Billing events	Time entry created, invoice issued, payment captured, write-off approved
Access events	User added, role changed, matter permission changed, login anomaly
Client events	Portal invitation, upload received, update sent, message viewed

8. Matter Workflows by Practice Area

Workflow packs are the local moat. Each workflow pack should define stages, required documents, recommended tasks, deadline prompts, readiness checks, AI templates, and document pack outputs.

Litigation

Stage	Operational detail
Intake and conflict check	Capture parties, cause of action, jurisdiction, urgency, prescription risk
Pleadings	Summons, notice, plea, replication, exceptions where applicable
Discovery	Discovery notices, document requests, bundle preparation
Pre-trial	Witnesses, expert reports, pre-trial minute, settlement discussion
Trial preparation	Counsel brief, bundle index, chronology, issue list

Debt collection

Stage	Operational detail
Intake	Creditor, debtor, amount, source documents, last payment, acknowledgement
Pre-action	Demand letter, section 129 where applicable, payment proposal
Summons preparation	Jurisdiction, address verification, amount reconciliation
Judgment and enforcement	Default judgment, warrant, attachment, payment arrangement
Collections monitoring	Promise-to-pay tracking, follow-up reminders, settlement status

Labour

Stage	Operational detail
Intake	Dismissal date, reason, internal process, documents, desired outcome
CCMA readiness	Referral deadline, case number, notice of set down
Evidence bundle	Disciplinary record, correspondence, witness statements, employment contract
Arbitration prep	Chronology, issues, witnesses, settlement mandate
Outcome	Award, settlement agreement, review decision

Conveyancing

Stage	Operational detail
Instruction	Sale agreement, parties, property, purchase price, bond status
Onboarding	FICA, POPIA, mandates, marital status, company documents
Clearances	Rates, levy, transfer duty, bond cancellation
Lodgement readiness	Signatures, guarantees, documents, deeds office checklist
Registration and closure	Registration confirmation, final accounts, client communication

Estates

Stage	Operational detail
Initial intake	Death certificate, will, next of kin, assets, liabilities
Appointment	Executor documents, Master's Office submission
Administration	Inventory, claims, accounts, notices
L&D account	Draft, inspection, objections, finalisation
Distribution and closure	Payments, transfers, final report

RAF / personal injury

Stage	Operational detail
Intake	Accident date, location, SAPS case, injuries, hospital data
Evidence collection	Medical reports, accident report, witness statements, employment/income proof
Chronology	Medical timeline, treatment, loss of earnings, prognosis
Quantum preparation	Heads of damages, expert reports, settlement range
Litigation/settlement	Offer tracking, court dates, final settlement

9. Role-Based Dashboards and UX

Legal Matters should be role-based. A partner needs firm health; an attorney needs matters requiring attention; a paralegal needs tasks and document requests; accounts needs unbilled work and payments; clients need simple status and document requests.

9.1 Legal Command Centre

Daily command centre example

Today: 7 deadlines due; 4 client messages waiting; 3 matters at prescription risk; 12 documents awaiting review; R86,400 in overdue invoices.

AI Recommendations: review inactive matters, send client updates, capture missing time, upload signed mandates, check upcoming court dates.

9.2 Dashboard cards

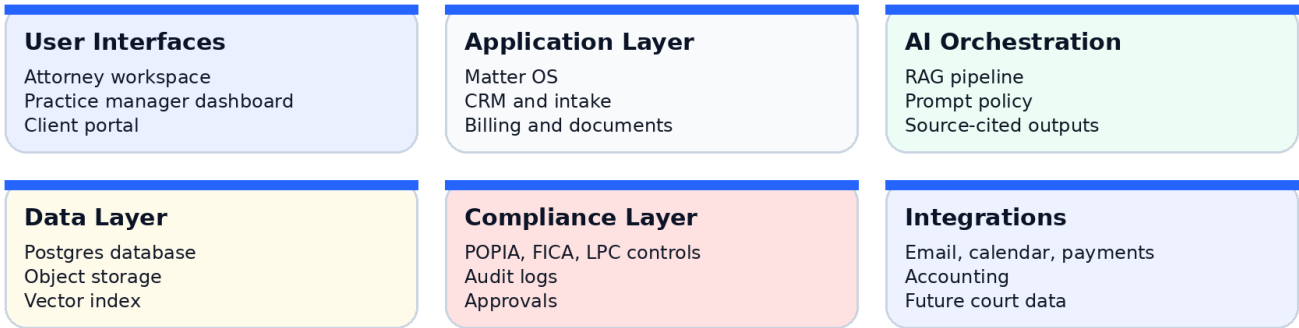
Dashboard	Cards and widgets
Attorney dashboard	Today’s deadlines, assigned tasks, high-risk matters, documents awaiting review, client updates due, AI suggested actions
Partner dashboard	Firm revenue, matter risk, staff workload, pipeline, overdue invoices, profitability by matter type
Practice manager dashboard	Overdue tasks, inactive matters, workflow bottlenecks, missing FICA/POPIA, document backlog
Accounts dashboard	Unbilled time, draft invoices, unpaid invoices, payments, expenses, trust/client funds flags
Client portal	Matter status, next step, documents required, messages, invoices, secure upload, approvals

9.3 UX principles

- Mobile-first for quick attorney tasks such as notes, deadlines, document upload, and client updates.
- Desktop-first for firm dashboards, document review, billing, bundle building, and workflow administration.
- Every matter page should show: status, next step, risk, missing documents, deadlines, tasks, documents, billing, and AI actions.
- Use clear status colours: green for healthy, amber for attention, red for urgent risk, blue for information.
- Keep AI actions contextual: “Summarise this matter,” “Draft client update,” “Create chronology,” “Check readiness.”

10. Data Model and Technical Architecture

Legal Matters Platform Architecture



Design principle: AI is embedded into verified workflows, not offered as an uncontrolled standalone chatbot.

10.1 Recommended stack

Layer	Recommended choice	Reason
Frontend	Next.js App Router + React + Tailwind + shadcn/ui	Fast SaaS UI, role-based dashboards, modern component system
Backend	Next.js API routes initially; optional FastAPI service for AI/document processing	Simple MVP, scalable path for AI workloads
Database	Postgres with row-level tenancy design	Strong relational model for legal matters and audit logs
Storage	Object storage for documents with signed URLs	Secure document storage
Vector search	pgvector or managed vector index	Matter/document retrieval for AI
Auth	Clerk, Firebase Auth, Supabase Auth, or custom enterprise auth	Tenant-aware authentication
AI	Provider-agnostic AI orchestration layer	Avoid lock-in and support policy control
Observability	Structured logs, audit logs, error tracking, metrics	Production discipline
Deployment	Vercel/Netlify for web + managed database/storage	Simple MVP deployment

10.2 Core entities

Entity group A	Entity group B	Entity group C
firms	users	roles
permissions	clients	client_contacts
matters	matter_types	matter_stages

matter_tasks	matter_deadlines	matter_notes
documents	document_versions	document_ai_summaries
ai_outputs	ai_audit_logs	intake_forms
conflict_checks	fica_records	popia_consent
time_entries	expenses	invoices
payments	trust_transactions	client_messages
matter_events	workflow_templates	workflow_steps
matter_readiness_checks	risk_alerts	notifications

10.3 Database design principles

- Every tenant-owned table must include firm_id.
- Every matter-owned table should include matter_id and firm_id for query safety and audit simplicity.
- Important tables should include created_by, created_at, updated_by, updated_at, and status fields.
- Documents must separate metadata from file storage paths and AI extraction records.
- AI outputs must be immutable once approved; revised outputs should create a new version.
- Audit logs should be append-only and queryable by matter, user, event type, and date.

10.4 Suggested schema starter

Table: matters

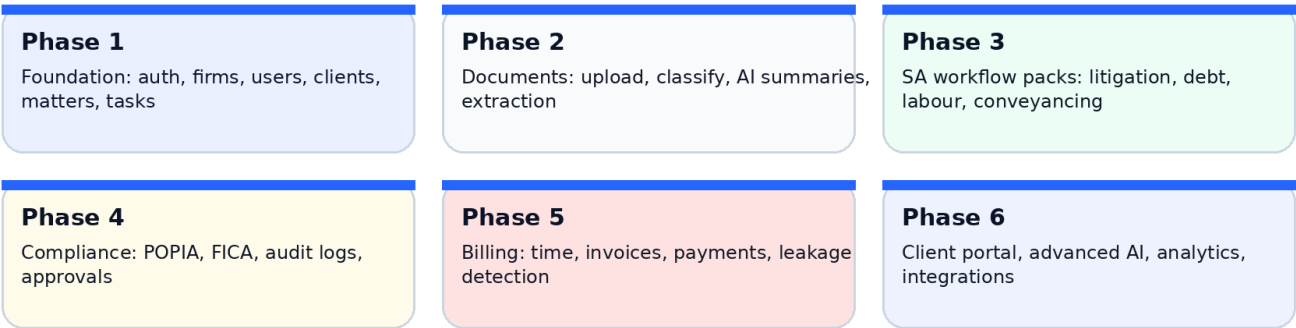
- id uuid primary key
- firm_id uuid not null
- client_id uuid not null
- matter_number text not null
- title text not null
- matter_type_id uuid
- stage_id uuid
- status text check in ('lead','open','on_hold','closed','archived')
- responsible_user_id uuid
- risk_level text check in ('low','medium','high','critical')
- readiness_score numeric
- opened_at timestampz
- closed_at timestampz
- created_by uuid
- created_at timestampz default now()
- updated_at timestampz default now()

Table: ai_outputs

- id uuid primary key
- firm_id uuid not null
- matter_id uuid
- document_id uuid
- output_type text not null
- prompt_category text not null
- content jsonb not null
- sources jsonb not null
- confidence text
- status text check in ('draft','reviewed','approved','rejected','superseded')
- generated_by uuid
- approved_by uuid
- created_at timestampz default now()

11. MVP Scope, Roadmap, and Delivery Gates

Recommended Product Roadmap



Each phase must ship with acceptance criteria, tests, migration scripts, and rollback guidance.

11.1 MVP scope

MVP feature	Included capability
Authentication and firm setup	Firm registration, users, roles, basic permissions
Client CRM	Clients, contacts, conflict check, FICA/POPIA status
Matter management	Matter profile, stages, status, team, tasks, deadlines, notes
Documents	Upload, classify, link to matter, AI summary, key field extraction
AI assistant	Matter summary, document summary, client update draft, suggested tasks
Billing basics	Time entries, expenses, invoices, unpaid/unbilled dashboard
Dashboards	Deadlines, overdue tasks, high-risk matters, unbilled work, AI actions
Audit logs	Critical action logging
Workflow templates	At least litigation, debt collection, labour, conveyancing starter templates

11.2 Must/Should/Could/Won't for MVP

Priority	Features
Must	Firm/users/roles, clients, matters, tasks, deadlines, document upload, AI summary, audit log, dashboard
Should	FICA/POPIA checklist, conflict check, workflow templates, billing basics, readiness score
Could	Client portal preview, document comparison, voice note capture, bundle index export
Won't initially	Full trust accounting, court filing integration, full accounting

	integration, mobile app, AI legal research engine
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11.3 Delivery acceptance gates

Gate	Acceptance criteria
Security gate	Tenant isolation tested; role permissions enforced; sensitive routes protected
Workflow gate	Each MVP workflow template has stages, required fields, tasks, documents, readiness checks
AI gate	AI outputs show sources, confidence, missing info, approval status, and audit entries
Document gate	Upload/download works; file metadata stored; AI summary linked to document and matter
Billing gate	Time entries can be captured, invoiced, marked paid, and reported
UX gate	Attorney can see what needs attention within 30 seconds of opening dashboard
QA gate	Unit tests, integration tests, seed data, and manual test scripts pass

12. Pricing, Packaging, and Go-to-Market

Pricing should be affordable enough for South African firms but structured to capture value from AI, automation, compliance, and analytics. The core should be priced per user, with AI document credits or bundles layered on top.

12.1 Suggested packages

Plan	Target	Included direction	Indicative price band
Starter	Solo attorneys	Clients, matters, tasks, deadlines, basic documents, limited AI	R399-R799/user/month
Professional	Small firms	Workflow templates, AI summaries, billing basics, dashboards	R899-R1,499/user/month
Practice Pro	Growing firms	Readiness engine, risk radar, client portal, advanced billing, more AI	R1,499-R2,499/user/month
Enterprise	Larger firms	Custom permissions, advanced audit, integrations, migration support	Custom
AI credits	Usage add-on	Document extraction, drafting, comparison, bundle generation	Bundle or per-document pricing

12.2 Ideal first target users

- Small litigation and debt-collection practices with document-heavy repeatable workflows.
- Labour-law practices that need deadline discipline, evidence bundles, and client updates.
- Conveyancing firms needing document checklists, onboarding, client status updates, and workflow visibility.
- General practice firms needing a single system for matters, tasks, documents, billing, and AI assistance.

12.3 Sales message

Commercial message

Legal Matters reduces admin, prevents missed steps, improves client communication, helps capture more billable work, and gives firm owners visibility across every matter.

13. Antigravity 2 Build Guidance

Use Antigravity 2 in a specification-first workflow. The goal is to prevent the AI builder from generating disconnected screens or shallow features. Each build phase should include requirements, acceptance criteria, database changes, UI routes, tests, seed data, and review gates.

13.1 Repository structure

```
legal-matters/  
  app/  
    (auth)/  
    (dashboard)/  
    api/  
  components/  
    ui/  
    legal/  
  dashboards/  
  matter/  
  documents/  
  lib/  
    auth/  
    db/  
    ai/  
    audit/  
    permissions/  
    workflows/  
  prisma/ or db/  
    schema.sql  
    migrations/  
    seed.ts  
  tests/  
    unit/  
    integration/  
    e2e/  
  docs/  
    product/  
    architecture/  
    workflows/  
    qa/
```

13.2 Antigravity planning prompt

/plan

You are the principal product architect and senior full-stack engineer for Legal Matters, an AI-powered South African legal operating platform.

Goal: Build the MVP foundation for a multi-tenant legal practice platform.

Use this blueprint as the source of truth. Produce:

1. Route map
2. Data model
3. Component map
4. API map
5. Permission model
6. Seed data plan
7. Test plan
8. Risks and assumptions
9. Build sequence with small commits

Non-negotiables:

- Tenant isolation by firm_id
- Matter-first data model
- Audit logs for critical actions
- Source-cited AI outputs
- Human approval for external communications
- POPIA/FICA/LPC-aware compliance fields

13.3 Antigravity build prompt

/build

Implement Phase 1: Foundation.

Scope:

- Authentication guard placeholders or configured auth integration
- Firm model
- User roles and permissions
- Client CRM basic screens
- Matter management basic screens
- Tasks and deadlines
- Audit log service
- Dashboard shell

Acceptance criteria:

- User can create and view clients
- User can create and view matters linked to clients
- User can create tasks and deadlines linked to matters
- Dashboard shows upcoming deadlines and overdue tasks
- All tenant-owned records include firm_id
- Critical create/update/delete actions write audit_log records
- Include seed data for one demo firm, three users, five clients, and six matters
- Include tests for permission checks and matter CRUD

13.4 Phase prompts

Phase	Prompt goal
Phase 1	Build foundation: auth, firm, users, clients, matters, tasks, deadlines, audit logs
Phase 2	Build document hub: upload, metadata, matter linkage, AI summary placeholders, extraction schema
Phase 3	Build AI orchestration: matter summary, document summary, client update draft, source records, approval status
Phase 4	Build compliance hub: POPIA, FICA, conflict checks, role permissions, audit dashboard

Phase 5	Build billing basics: time, expenses, invoices, payments, unbilled dashboard
Phase 6	Build workflow packs and readiness engine for priority matter types

14. Testing and Quality Assurance

14.1 Test categories

Test type	What to test
Unit tests	Permission helpers, readiness score calculation, deadline status, billing totals, AI output schema validation
Integration tests	Matter creation, document upload, AI output creation, audit log creation, invoice flow
E2E tests	Client intake to matter creation, upload document to AI summary, deadline dashboard, billing flow
Security tests	Tenant isolation, role restrictions, direct URL access, document access, admin-only screens
AI tests	Source citation required, missing info flagged, approval status recorded, excluded documents not used
Compliance tests	POPIA consent state, FICA checklist, conflict check status, audit export
Performance tests	Dashboard load, document list load, search, matter timeline, large document metadata handling

14.2 Manual QA checklist

- Create a firm, add users, assign roles, and verify screen access.
- Create a client, run conflict check, capture FICA and POPIA status.
- Create a litigation matter, add tasks, deadlines, notes, and documents.
- Generate an AI matter summary and verify sources, confidence, missing information, and audit entry.
- Create time entries, invoice the matter, mark payment, and verify dashboard totals.
- Confirm restricted users cannot see unauthorised matters or confidential documents.
- Export or view audit logs for a matter and verify critical actions are present.

14.3 Definition of Done

Item	Done means
Feature	Implemented, tested, seeded, documented, and visible in UI
Database	Migration included, rollback considered, seed data updated
Security	Permissions checked server-side, not only hidden in UI
AI	Output schema enforced, sources captured, approval state recorded
Audit	Critical event logged with user, firm, matter, timestamp, and action
UX	Empty states, loading states, errors, and mobile responsiveness handled
Release	Build passes, tests pass, manual QA completed, known risks documented

15. Appendices

15.1 MVP user stories

Role	User story	Acceptance
Attorney	As an attorney, I want to see all matters needing attention today so I can prioritise my work.	Dashboard shows deadlines, overdue tasks, high-risk matters, client updates due.
Paralegal	As a paralegal, I want to upload documents and have them classified so I can organise matter files faster.	Uploaded documents can be classified, linked to matter, summarised by AI.
Practice manager	As a practice manager, I want to see inactive matters so I can prevent client neglect.	Dashboard lists matters with no activity beyond configured threshold.
Accounts user	As accounts staff, I want to see unbilled time so invoices are not missed.	Billing dashboard shows unbilled entries by matter and responsible user.
Client	As a client, I want to know what documents are required from me.	Portal shows outstanding requests and secure upload option.

15.2 Gherkin examples

Feature: Matter Readiness

Scenario: A debt collection matter is missing required documents

Given a debt collection matter exists

And no signed agreement has been uploaded

And no proof of delivery has been uploaded

When the readiness engine runs

Then the readiness score should be below 80

And the system should list the signed agreement as missing

And the system should list proof of delivery as missing

Feature: AI Source-Cited Summary

Scenario: User generates a matter summary

Given a matter has uploaded documents and notes

When the user generates an AI matter summary

Then the output must include sources used

And the output must include missing information

And an AI audit log entry must be created

15.3 Source notes

This blueprint was informed by Filevine's public positioning around AI legal software and by South African legal-practice compliance considerations. Official/public source notes used for orientation include:

- Filevine AI features and solutions: <https://www.filevine.com/platform/ai-features-and-solutions/>
- Filevine legal AI and operating intelligence homepage: <https://www.filevine.com/>
- Legal Practice Council mandate and regulatory role: <https://lpc.org.za/>
- LPC trust account engagement notices: <https://lpc.org.za/engagements-on-legal-practitioners-trust-accounts/>
- Financial Intelligence Centre Act reference: <https://www.fic.gov.za/wp-content/uploads/2023/10/Financial-Intelligence-Centre-Act-2001-Act-38-of-2001.pdf>
- LSSA FIC advisories and guidelines: <https://www.lssa.org.za/financial-intelligence-centre-advisories-and-guidelines/>

15.4 Immediate next actions

7. Approve the MVP scope and remove anything that is not needed for the first working version.
8. Choose the first three workflow packs: recommended starting set is litigation, debt collection, and labour or conveyancing.
9. Create the database schema and seed data for a realistic demo firm.
10. Build the Matter OS foundation before advanced AI.
11. Add document upload and AI summaries as the first wow feature.
12. Add readiness score and risk radar immediately after basic matter workflows.
13. Use Antigravity 2 phase prompts to build in small verified increments.